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Beaver Valley Traction Company

The Beaver Valley Traction Company was an [interurban street railway operations](#) in the [U.S.](#) state of [Pennsylvania](#) . The 56 km network linking the towns of [Rochester](#) , [Beaver](#) , [Freedom](#) , [Ambridge](#) , [Leetsdale](#) , [New Brighton](#) and [Monaca](#) .

On 17 September 1884 *Beaver Valley Street Railway Company* was founded, on 4 July 1885 a [horse tram](#) from Beaver Falls to New Brighton opened. The *Beaver Valley Traction Company* on 29 Founded in June 1891, bought the horse track and electrified them. On 5 December 1891 was recorded the electrical and extended the route to Beaver. Meanwhile, in 1891 founded the *People's Electric Street Railway*, on 13 August of an electric tram from Rochester to Freedom opened. The *River View Electric Street Railway* built a line from the center of New Brighton to Beaver Falls. This track was on the eastern bank of the [Beaver River](#) , while the Beaver Valley Street Railway on the west bank was. A short branch line to Monaca was on 31 July 1893 by the *College and Grand View Electric Street Railway Company* opened. All these street railway companies merged on 1 October 1900 to the *Beaver Valley Traction Company*. The network was built in Pennsylvania in the popular gauge of 5 feet 2 ½ inches (1588 millimeters) and was operated at 550 volts direct current. Depot, office and workshop of the train were in Rochester.

The railway company operating the following lines:

- Beaver Falls-New Brighton-Patterson Heights Rochester-Beaver, Vanport (8 km, every 30 minutes)
- Beaver-Rochester-Freedom-Ambridge, Leetsdale (22.5 km, every 20 minutes)
- Rochester-Monaca (2.5 km, every 10 minutes)
- Beaver Falls-New Brighton Downtown (3,5 km, every 20 minutes)
- Rochester-New Brighton-Patterson Heights Beaver Falls Morado (12 km, every 20 minutes)

In Vanport shut the [tram Steubenville-Beaver](#) in the Beaver Valley, unlike the [normal track](#) was built. The [Pittsburgh, Harmony, Butler and New Castle Railway](#) had a branch line to Morado, the northern continuation of the route of the Beaver Valley was the. Be a continuous traffic came here in spite of the same gauge not take place. Freedom in the transition was on the tram route Freedom Leetsdale, the *Pittsburgh and Beaver Street Railway Company* had been built by the 1908th The tram line to the Freedom drove by opening the route to Leetsdale. For building up the company has two subsidiaries. In [Beaver County](#) , this was the *Ambridge and Baden Street Railway Company* and in [Allegheny County](#) , where the last stage piece Leetsdale was up to, this was the *Ambridge, Leetsdale and Edgewood Street Railway*. The custodian of this railway was in Ambridge. These two companies merged in 1921 with the Pittsburgh & Beaver, which is owned by the [Philadelphia Company](#) was located. The Philadelphia company bought 1922 at the Beaver Valley Traction Company.

The branch line to the city of New Brighton, on 1 September 1924 shut down, followed by the line of Ambridge to Leetsdale in April 1925. 1933 ended the tram service between Rochester and Ambridge in 1935 between Park Junction and Rochester. On 10 August 1937 was set to run on the final leg,

namely the line Morado-Beaver Falls-Junction Park.

[[edit](#)] References

- Benson W. Rohrbeck (1997): *Pennsylvania's Street Railways* West Chester PA: Traction Publications. Page 252
- Benson W. Rohrbeck (2007): *Pennsylvania Railway Street Atlas* West Chester PA: Ben Rohrbeck Traction Publications. Page 61

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- [historical summary](#) 

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